

GENERAL ENGLISH TEXTBOOK



**SRI SATHYA SAI INSTITUTE OF HIGHER LEARNING
(DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY)**



SYLLABUS FOR - GENERAL ENGLISH

(For the students of all the streams of undergraduate programmes)

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(EFFECTIVE FROM JUNE 2023 BATCH ONWARDS)

M. G. Kalu
27.01.2024

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Sri Sathya Sai District, A.P. - 515 134
India

SYLLABUS FOR GENERAL ENGLISH

SRI SATHYA SAI INSTITUTE OF HIGHER LEARNING

(DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY)

SCHEME OF INSTRUCTION & EVALUATION

Name of the Course: Ability Enhancement Course: General English
(EFFECTIVE FROM JUNE 2023 BATCH ONWARDS)

Paper Code	Title of the Paper	Course Category #	Credits	Hours	Mode of Evaluation	Type of Paper	Max. Marks
SEMESTER 1							
UELS-101	English Language Skills - I	AEC	3		IE1	L, T, P	100
SEMESTER 2							
UELS-201	English Language Skills-II	AEC	3	3	IE1	L, T, P	100
SEMESTER 3							
UELS-301	English Language Skills-III	AEC	3	3	IE1	L, T, P	100
Grand Total			9	9			300
*AEC – Ability Enhancement Course							
Indicator	Legend						
L/T/P	Lecture/Tutorial/Practical						
IE1	CIE and ESE; ESE single evaluation						
I	Continuous Internal Evaluation (CIE) only (Note: 'I' does not connote 'Internal Examiner')						
E	End Semester Examination (ESE) only (Note: 'E' does not connote 'External Examiner')						



PAPER CODE: UEIS-101	TITLE OF THE PAPER: ENGLISH LANGUAGE SKILLS-I	L 1	T 1	P 1	CREDITS: 3
Course Category:	Ability Enhancement Course	Total Hours: 42			
Prerequisites (if any): None					
Course Objectives: The course aims to – • give students the exposure to language use in literary and non-literary contexts. • revisit the basic aspects of English grammar to encourage error-free language use. • improve students' basic language skills, especially Listening and Reading through the Aural / Oral components. • provide opportunity to read literature that shapes minds.					
Course Outcomes: At the end of the course, the student will be able to – • understand and differentiate the Parts of Speech and use them correctly. • avoid grammatical errors pertaining to SV-agreement and verb tenses. • write effective formal letters with appropriate diction and in the right tone and format. • comprehend and retain reading material effectively. • take notes of lectures/ textual reading efficiently.					
Unit	Description	Hours			
I	Detailed Study (Prose and Poetry): 1. Rabindranath Tagore: Verse 11 "Leave This Changing" from <i>Gitanjali</i> 2. A.G. Gardiner: "On Letter Writing" 3. O' Henry: "After Twenty Years"	9			
II	4. Grammar: a) Parts of Speech b) verbs: Tense & Aspect c) Subject-Verb Agreement 5. Written Communication: Formal Letter Types: Request, Inquiry, Order, Complaint, etc.	10			
	6. Study Skills: a) SQ3R Method b) Note-making 7. Vocabulary (Based on the prescribed texts for detailed study).	6			
III	8. Non-Detailed Text: Mitch Albom: <i>Tuesdays with Morrie</i> 9. Oral Communication: Conversation Skills (for CIEs) a) Reading Aloud: (Testing Pronunciation, Stress, Intonation, and Rhythm) b) Note-Taking (Testing the Listening Skill)	5			

M. G. K. K. K.



Reference Text/Materials:	Topics covered	Prescribed chapter/ Sections
1. Anthology of Poetry and Prose (to be prepared in-house for internal circulation only) 2. David Green, <i>Contemporary English Grammar, Structures and Composition</i>, Laxmi Publications, 2016, ISBN- 97893513812 3. Formal Letters: https://owl.excelsior.edu/writing-for-your-career/cover-letters/ 4. <i>Tuesdays With Morrie: An old man, a young man, and life's greatest lesson</i> by Albom, Mitch, Sphere:1 December 1998, ISBN-10: 0751527378/ ISBN-13: 978-0751527377 5. Summarising, https://owl.excelsior.edu/research/drafting-and-integratingrafting-and-integrating-summarizing/ 6. Nira Kunal, <i>Communication Skills for Professionals</i>, PHI Learning, (ISBN- 9788120344204), India, 2022. 7. Sarah Freeman, <i>Written Communication in English</i>, Orient Blackswan, India, 1977 8. A.K. Behera, <i>Speaking English Confidently and Fluently</i>, BFC Publications, 2022, ISBN- 978-93-5632-282-0	Detailed Text Grammar and composition Formal letter Non-detailed text Unit- 3 Listening Skills Unit- 3 Reading Skills Unit – 2 Formal letters	Units 2, Units 11 to 17 Whole book for Unit 3, Item 7
Suggested/Additional Readings: 1. Rodney Huddleston and Geoffrey K. Pullum, <i>A Student's Introduction to English Grammar</i>, Cambridge University Press, 2021, ISBN 0 521 68322X 2. P. N. Gopalakrishnan, <i>Book of Nouns</i>, Authorspress, 2015, ISBN 81-7273-256-2 3. Michael Swan, <i>Basic English Usage</i>, QUP, 1984, ISBN-10: 0194311872 4. P. N. Gopalakrishnan, <i>Book of Adjectives</i>, Authorspress, Delhi, 2006, ISBN 81-7273-270-8 5. P. Christophersen and A. O. Sandved, <i>An Advanced English Grammar</i>, Macmillan Student Edition, London, 1969, ISBN 0 333 10643 1 6. Raymond Murphy, <i>Essential English Grammar</i> (2nd Edition), Cambridge, Britain, 1994		



9/10/20

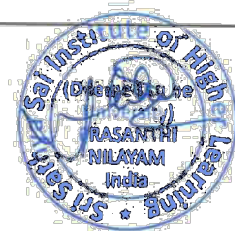
PAPER CODE:	TITLE OF THE PAPER	L	T	P	CREDITS
WEL-201	ENGLISH LANGUAGE SKILLS - II	1	1	1	3

Course Code for : **BAHAI ENHANCEMENT COURSE** Total Hours: 48

Prerequisite if any : None

Course Objectives:

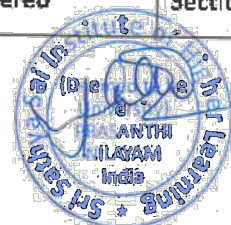
6. A.K. Behera, <i>Speaking English Confidently and Fluently</i> , BFC Publications, 2022, ISBN- 978-93-5632-282-0 7. Sasikumar V., et al., <i>Communication Skills in English</i> , Foundation Books. 8. Sasikumar V., et al., <i>A Course in Listening and Speaking (I & II)</i> . Bangalore: Foundation Books, 2006. 9. AI-related Prompt Engineering blogs	Oral Communication Unit-2 IT Skills	
Suggested/Additional Readings: 1. Raymond Murphy, <i>Essential English Grammar</i> (2nd Edition), Cambridge University Press, 1999, ISBN 81-7596-029-9 2. Rodney Huddleston and Geoffrey K. Pullum, <i>A Student's Introduction to English Grammar</i>, Cambridge University Press, India, 2021, Edition 2, ISBN 0 521 68322X 3. Thomson and Martinet, <i>A Practical English Grammar</i>, Oxford, India, Edition 4, 1986 4. Champa Tickoo & Jaya Sasikumar, <i>Writing with a Purpose</i>, OUP, 1997, ISBN: 0195611608		



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PAPER CODE: UELS-301		TITLE OF THE PAPER ENGLISH LANGUAGE SKILLS - III		L 1	T 1	P 1	CREDITS: 3
Course Category:		Ability Enhancement Course		Total Hours: 42			
Prerequisites (if any): None							
Course Objectives: The course aims to – • give students the exposure to language use in literary and non-literary contexts. • revise the basic aspects of English grammar to encourage error-free language use. • improve in students, basic LSRW skills through the Aural / Oral components. • provide opportunity to read literature that shapes minds.							
Course Outcomes: At the end of the course, the students will be able to – • distinguish between Phrases and Clauses and avoid sentence fragments. • construct various types of sentences. • write well-organised essays. • transpose given information from Visual mode to Verbal mode. • report events and discussions effectively. • perform basic communicative tasks like making enquiries, requests, announcements etc. • employ different communicative methods to express opinions in Group Discussions.							
Unit	Description						Hours
I	Detailed study (Prose and Poetry): 1. Emily Dickinson: "In a Library" 2. Ruskin Bond: "Joyfully I Write" 3. Saadat Hasan Manto: "Toba Tek Singh"						8
II	4. Grammar: a) Phrases, Clauses, and Conjunctions b) Simple, Compound, Complex, and Compound-Complex Sentences 5. Written Communication: Essay Writing with Sentence Outline (the five-paragraph format)						9 7
	6. Study Skills: a) Report Writing b) Channel Conversion - Transpose Visual to Verbal 7. Vocabulary (Based on the prescribed texts for detailed study)						4
III	8. Non-Detailed Text: Ben Carson: <i>The Gifted Hands</i> 9. Aural/Oral Communication (for CIEs): a) Introducing, Announcing, Making Enquiries and Requests, Seeking Permissions b) Group Discussion						6 8
Reference Text/Materials:				Topics covered		Prescribed chapter/ Sections	

M. G. Talwar



1. Anthology of Poetry and Prose compiled for internal circulation only 2. David Green, <i>Contemporary English Grammar, Structures and Composition</i>, Laxmi Publications, India edition 2, 2015, ISBN- 9789351381273 3. Essay Writing, https://owl.excelsior.edu/writing-process/essay-writing/ 4. Ben Carson: <i>The Gifted Hands</i> 5. Nira Kunal, <i>Communication Skills for Professionals</i>, PHI Learning, India, 2022, ISBN- 9788120344204 6. A.K. Behera, <i>Speaking English Confidently and Fluently</i>, BFC Publications, 2022, ISBN- 978-93-5632-282-0	Detailed Text Grammar and composition Essay Writing Grammar Text Group Discussion	Units 2, 21, 23, 25
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Suggested/Additional Readings:

1. Raymond Murphy, *Essential English Grammar* (2nd Edition), Cambridge University Press, 1999, ISBN 81-7596-029-9
2. Rodney Huddleston and Geoffrey K. Pullum, *A Student's Introduction to English Grammar*, Cambridge University Press, India, 2021, Edition 2, ISBN 0 521 68322X
3. Thomson and Martinet, *A Practical English Grammar*, Oxford, India, Edition 4, 1986
4. *Confidence in Writing* (4th Edition), Ed. by Reynolds and Marcia Huntington, Heinle and Heinle Publications, 2001, ISBN 0-15-507074-6
5. Champa Tickoo & Jaya Sasikumar, *Writing with a Purpose*, OUP, 1997, ISBN: 0195611608

M. A. K. K.

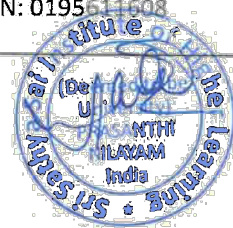


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UELS 101

ENGLISH LANGUAGE
SKILLS - I

Leave This Chanting

RABINDRANATH TAGORE

Leave this chanting and singing and telling of beads!
Whom dost thou worship in this lonely dark corner of a temple with doors all
shut? Open thine eyes and see thy God is not before thee!

He is there where the tiller is tilling the hard ground
and where the pathmaker is breaking stones. He is
with them in sun and in shower,
and his garment is covered with dust.
Put off thy holy mantle and even like him come down on the dusty soil!

Deliverance?
Where is this deliverance to be found?
Our master himself has joyfully taken upon him the bonds of
creation; he is bound with us all for ever.

Come out of thy meditations and leave aside thy flowers and incense!
What harm is there if thy clothes become tattered and stained?
Meet him and stand by him in toil and in sweat of thy brow.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Rabindranath Tagore, the illustrious Bengali poet, painter, and philosopher, stands as a towering figure in the world of literature. Born on May 7, 1861 in Calcutta, India, Tagore's poetic genius traversed the realms of emotion, spirituality, and human experience, leaving an indelible mark on generations to come.

Tagore's poetry, characterized by its lyrical beauty and profound philosophical insights, transcends boundaries of time and space, resonating with readers across cultures and generations. His verses, imbued with a deep sense of spirituality and humanism, reflect his belief in the unity of all existence and the interconnectedness of life. In his seminal work *Gitanjali*, which earned him the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1913, Tagore explores themes of love, devotion, and the search for the divine. Each poem in *Gitanjali* is a lyrical masterpiece, expressing the poet's intimate dialogue with God and his reverence for the beauty of the natural world. Tagore's poetry is also deeply rooted in the cultural and spiritual traditions of India, drawing inspiration from ancient texts such as the *Upanishads* and the *Bhagavad Gita*. His exploration of themes such as the cycle of life and death, the ephemeral nature of existence, and the pursuit of inner peace reflects his profound understanding of Hindu philosophy.

Beyond his literary achievements, Tagore was a visionary thinker and social reformer, advocating for universal education, women's rights, and the abolition of caste discrimination. His ideals of tolerance, compassion, and harmony continue to inspire millions around the world.

Tagore's influence extended far beyond the realm of literature, as he was also a prolific composer and musician. He composed over 2,000 songs, known as "Rabindra Sangeet," which remain an integral part of Bengali culture and are celebrated for their melodic beauty and lyrical depth.

SUMMARY

The poet wants ascetics to participate in the daily humble activities of life for the realization of God. The poet advises the ascetics to give up chanting of Mantras, singing of Bhajan, and counting the beads of a rosary.

THEME

Leave this chanting and singing is a great spiritual poem by Tagore. In it, Tagore advises man to search for God through hard work rather than following the passive rituals of orthodox religion.

On Letter-Writing

A G GARDINER

Two soldiers, evidently brothers, stood at the door of the railway carriage--one inside the compartment, the other on the platform.

"Now, you won't forget to write, Bill," said the latter.

"No," said Bill. "I shall be back at--tonight, and I'll write all round to-morrow. But, lor, what a job. There's mother and the missus and Bob and Sarah and Aunt Jane and Uncle Jim, and--well, you know the lot. You've had to do it, Sam."

"Yes," said Sam, ruefully; "it's a fair teaser." "And if you write to one and miss another they're offended," continued Bill. "But I always mention all of 'em. I say 'love to Sarah,' and 'hope Aunt Jane's cold's better,' and that sort of thing, and that fills out a page. But I'm blowed if I can find anything else to say. I just begin 'hoping this finds you well, as it leaves me at present,' and then I'm done. What else is there to say?"

"Nothing," said Sam, mournfully. "I just sit and scratch my head over the blessed paper, but nothing'll come. Seems as though my head's as empty as a drum."

"Same here.'Tisn't like writing love-letters. When I was up to that game 'twas easy enough. When I got stuck I just put in half a page of crosses, and that filled up fine. But writing to mother and the missus and Sarah and Jim and the rest is different. You can't fill up with crosses. It would look ridiklus."

"It would," said Sam.

Then the train began to move, and the soldier in the train sank back on his seat, took out a cigarette, and began to smoke. I found he had been twice out at the front, and was now home on sick leave. He had been at the battle of Mons, through the retreat to the Marne, the advance to the Aisne, the first battle of Ypres, and the fighting at Festubert. In a word, he had seen some of the greatest events in the world's history, face to face, and yet he confessed that when he came to writing a letter, even to his wife, he could find nothing to say. He was in the position of the lady mentioned by Horace Walpole, whose letter to her

husband began and ended thus: "I write to you because I have nothing to do: I finish because I have nothing to say."

I suppose there has never been so much letter-writing in the world as is going on to-day, and much of it is good writing, as the papers show. But the case of my companion in the train is the case of thousands and tens of thousands of young fellows who for the first time in their lives want to write and discover that they have no gift of self-expression. It is not that they are stupid. It is that somehow the act of writing paralyses them. They cannot condense the atmosphere in which they live to the concrete word. You have to draw them out. They need a friendly lead. When they have got that they can talk well enough, but without it they are dumb.

In the great sense letter-writing is no doubt a lost art. It was killed by the penny post and modern hurry. When Madame de Sevigny, Cowper, Horace Walpole, Byron, Lamb, and the Carlyles wrote their immortal letters the world was a leisurely place where there was time to indulge in the luxury of writing to your friends. And the cost of franking a letter made that letter a serious affair. If you could only send a letter once in a month or six months, and then at heavy expense, it became a matter of first-rate consequence. The poor, of course, couldn't enjoy the luxury of letter-writing at all. De Quincey tells us how the dalesmen of Lakeland a century ago used to dodge the postal charges. The letter that came by stage coach was received at the door by the poor mother, who glanced at the superscription, saw from a certain agreed sign on it that Tom or Jim was well, and handed it back to the carrier unopened. In those days a letter was an event.

Now when you can send a letter half round the globe for a penny, and when the postman calls half a dozen times a day, few of us take letter-writing seriously. Carlyle saw that the advent of the penny post would kill the letter by making it cheap. "I shall send a penny letter next time," he wrote to his mother when the cheap postage was about to come in, and he foretold that people would not bother to write good letters when they could send them for next to nothing. He was right, and the telegraph, the telephone, and the postcard have completed the destruction of the art of letter writing. It is the difficulty or the scarcity of a thing that makes it treasured. If diamonds were as plentiful as pebbles we shouldn't stoop to pick them up.

But the case of Bill and Sam and thousands of their comrades to-day is different. They don't want to write literary letters, but they do want to tell the folks at home something about their life and the great things of which they are a part. But the great things are too great for them. They cannot put them into words. And they ought not to try, for the secret of letter-writing is intimate triviality. Bill could not have described the retreat from Mons; but he could have told, as he told me, about the blister he got on his heel, how he hungered for a smoke, how he marched and marched until he fell asleep marching, how he lost his pal at Le Cateau, and how his boot sole dropped off at Meaux. And through such trivialities he would have given a living picture of the great retreat.

In short, to write a good letter you must approach the job in the lightest and most casual way. You must be personal, not abstract. You must not say, "This is too small a thing to put down." You must say, "This is just the sort of small thing we talk about at home. If I tell them this they will see me, as it were, they'll hear my voice, they'll know what I'm about." That is the purpose of a letter. Keats expresses the idea very well in one of those voluminous letters which he wrote to his brother George and his wife in America and in which he poured out the wealth of family affection which was one of the most amiable features of his character. He has described how he had been to see his mother, how she had laughed at his bad jokes, how they went out to tea at Mrs. Millar's, and how in going they were struck with the light and shade through the gateway at the Horse Guards. And he goes on: "I intend to write you such volumes that it will be impossible for me to keep any order or method in what I write; that will come first which is uppermost in my mind, not that which is uppermost in my heart--besides I should wish to give you a picture of our lives here whenever by a touch I can do it; even as you must see by the last sentence our walk past Whitehall all in good health and spirits--this I am certain of because I felt so much pleasure from the simple idea of your playing a game of cricket."

There is the recipe by one of the masters of the craft. A letter written in this vein annihilates distance; it continues the personal gossip, the intimate communion, that has been interrupted by separation; it preserves one's presence in absence. It cannot be too simple, too commonplace, too colloquial. Its familiarity is not its weakness, but its supreme virtue. If it attempts to be orderly and stately and elaborate, it may be a good essay, but it will certainly be a bad letter.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Alfred George Gardiner was born on 2 June 1865 in Chelmsford Essex in England. His father was Henry James Gardner and his mother was Susanna Gardiner. By occupation, he was a journalist, author, and editor. He started working at the Chelmsford Chronicle and Bournemouth directory in his boyhood. Later in 1887, he joined the Northern Daily Telegraph. He became the editor of the Blackburn weekly telegraph in 1899. He became the editor of the Daily News in 1902 but resigned the job in 1999. In 1915 he started writing for the Star magazine under the pseudonym Alpha of the Plough. He was asked to choose the name of a star as a pseudonym. So he chose Alpha, the brightest star in the Plough constellation.

He wrote many essays. Some of his popular works are *Pillars of Society* 1913, *Pebbles on the Shore* 1916, *Leaves in the Wind* 1920 *Many Furrows* 1924. He was also the chairman of the National Anti-Sweating League which campaigned for a minimum wage in the industry. This great English author died at the age of 80 on 3 March 1946 in Buckingham, England. Alfred George Gardiner wrote many books. Some of his notable books are *Pebbles on the Shore* (1916), *Leaves in the Wind* (1919), *Pillars of Society* (1913), *Mamy Furrows* (1924), *Prophets & Kings* (1908), *Life of George Cadbury* (1923) and *War Lords* (1915).

SUMMARY

Gardiner says that many letters are still being written today, and much of it is letters that have been well written. He comes to the conclusion that the two young men are simply unable to articulate their thoughts and feelings unless someone gives them a sort of opening.

After Twenty Years

O. HENRY

The policeman on the beat moved up the avenue impressively. The impressiveness was habitual and not for show, for spectators were few. The time was barely 10 o'clock at night, but chilly gusts of wind with a taste of rain in them had well nigh depeopled the streets.

Trying doors as he went, twirling his club with many intricate and artful movements, turning now and then to cast his watchful eye adown the pacific thoroughfare, the officer, with his stalwart form and slight swagger, made a fine picture of a guardian of the peace. The vicinity was one that kept early hours. Now and then you might see the lights of a cigar store or of an all-night lunch counter; but the majority of the doors belonged to business places that had long since been closed.

When about midway of a certain block the policeman suddenly slowed his walk. In the doorway of a darkened hardware store a man leaned, with an unlighted cigar in his mouth. As the policeman walked up to him the man spoke up quickly.

"It's all right, officer," he said, reassuringly. "I'm just waiting for a friend. It's an appointment made twenty years ago. Sounds a little funny to you, doesn't it? Well, I'll explain if you'd like to make certain it's all straight. About that long ago there used to be a restaurant where this store stands--'Big Joe' Brady's restaurant."

"Until five years ago," said the policeman. "It was torn down then."

The man in the doorway struck a match and lit his cigar. The light showed a pale, square-jawed face with keen eyes, and a little white scar near his right eyebrow. His scarfpin was a large diamond, oddly set.

"Twenty years ago to-night," said the man, "I dined here at 'Big Joe' Brady's with Jimmy Wells, my best chum, and the finest chap in the world. He and I were raised here in New York, just like two brothers, together. I was eighteen and Jimmy was twenty. The next morning I was to start for the West to make my fortune. You couldn't have dragged Jimmy out of New York; he thought it was the only place on earth. Well, we agreed that night that we would meet here again exactly twenty years from that date and time, no matter what our conditions might be or from what distance we might have to come. We figured that in twenty years each of us ought to have our destiny worked out and our fortunes made, whatever they were going to be."

"It sounds pretty interesting," said the policeman. "Rather a long time between meets, though, it seems to me. Haven't you heard from your friend since you left?"

"Well, yes, for a time we corresponded," said the other. "But after a year or two we lost track of each other. You see, the West is a pretty big proposition, and I kept hustling around over it pretty lively. But I know Jimmy will meet me here if he's alive, for he always was the truest, stanchest old chap in the world. He'll never forget. I came a thousand miles to stand in this door to-night, and it's worth it if my old partner turns up."

The waiting man pulled out a handsome watch, the lids of it set with small diamonds.

"Three minutes to ten," he announced. "It was exactly ten o'clock when we parted here at the restaurant door."

"Did pretty well out West, didn't you?" asked the policeman.

"You bet! I hope Jimmy has done half as well. He was a kind of plodder, though, good fellow as he was. I've had to compete with some of the sharpest wits going to get my pile. A man gets in a groove in New York. It takes the West to put a razor-edge on him."

The policeman twirled his club and took a step or two.

"I'll be on my way. Hope your friend comes around all right. Going to call time on him sharp?"

"I should say not!" said the other. "I'll give him half an hour at least. If Jimmy is alive on earth he'll be here by that time. So long, officer."

"Good-night, sir," said the policeman, passing on along his beat, trying doors as he went.

There was now a fine, cold drizzle falling, and the wind had risen from its uncertain puffs into a steady blow. The few foot passengers astir in that quarter hurried dismally and silently along with coat collars turned high and pocketed hands. And in the door of the hardware store the man who had come a thousand miles to fill an appointment, uncertain almost to absurdity, with the friend of his youth, smoked his cigar and waited.

About twenty minutes he waited, and then a tall man in a long overcoat, with collar turned up to his ears, hurried across from the opposite side of the street. He went directly to the waiting man.

"Is that you, Bob?" he asked, doubtfully.

"Is that you, Jimmy Wells?" cried the man in the door.

"Bless my heart!" exclaimed the new arrival, grasping both the other's hands with his own. "It's Bob, sure as fate. I was certain I'd find you here if you were still in existence. Well,

well, well! --twenty years is a long time. The old gone, Bob; I wish it had lasted, so we could have had another dinner there. How has the West treated you, old man?"

"Bully; it has given me everything I asked it for. You've changed lots, Jimmy. I never thought you were so tall by two or three inches."

"Oh, I grew a bit after I was twenty."

"Doing well in New York, Jimmy?"

"Moderately. I have a position in one of the city departments. Come on, Bob; we'll go around to a place I know of, and have a good long talk about old times."

The two men started up the street, arm in arm. The man from the West, his egotism enlarged by success, was beginning to outline the history of his career. The other, submerged in his overcoat, listened with interest.

At the corner stood a drug store, brilliant with electric lights. When they came into this glare each of them turned simultaneously to gaze upon the other's face.

The man from the West stopped suddenly and released his arm.

"You're not Jimmy Wells," he snapped. "Twenty years is a long time, but not long enough to change a man's nose from a Roman to a pug."

"It sometimes changes a good man into a bad one, said the tall man. "You've been under arrest for ten minutes, 'Silky' Bob. Chicago thinks you may have dropped over our way and wires us she wants to have a chat with you. Going quietly, are you? That's sensible. Now, before we go on to the station here's a note I was asked to hand you. You may read it here at the window. It's from Patrolman Wells."

The man from the West unfolded the little piece of paper handed him. His hand was steady when he began to read, but it trembled a little by the time he had finished. The note was rather short.

"Bob: I was at the appointed place on time. When you struck the match to light your cigar I saw it was the face of the man wanted in Chicago. Somehow I couldn't do it myself, so I went around and got a plain clothes man to do the job.

JIMMY."

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

William Sydney Porter, known by his pen name O. Henry, was a prolific American writer whose short stories captivated readers with their wit, humor, and unexpected twists. Born on September 11, 1862, in Greensboro, North Carolina, O. Henry's literary career flourished during the late 19th and early 20th centuries, earning him a place among the masters of the short story genre. O. Henry's stories are renowned for their clever plotting, colorful characters, and inventive use of language. His keen observations of human nature and his ability to evoke empathy and laughter in equal measure made him a beloved storyteller of his time and continue to enchant readers to this day.

One of O. Henry's trademarks is his penchant for surprise endings, often referred to as "O. Henry endings," where the narrative takes an unexpected turn, leaving readers delighted and astonished. His mastery of the twist ending is exemplified in classics such as "The Gift of the Magi" and "The Ransom of Red Chief." Despite his literary success, O. Henry's personal life was marked by adversity. In 1898, he was convicted of embezzlement and spent three years in prison. It was during this time that he began writing in earnest, using his experiences and observations to fuel his creative imagination.

Following his release from prison, O. Henry relocated to New York City, where he became a prominent figure in the city's literary circles. He contributed regularly to popular magazines such as "The Saturday Evening Post" and "Cosmopolitan," earning a loyal readership and critical acclaim. O. Henry's stories often explore themes of love, sacrifice, and the human condition, set against the backdrop of bustling city life. His characters, from down-on-their-luck drifters to cunning con artists, reflect the diverse tapestry of American society, capturing the essence of the era with warmth and humor.

SUMMARY

In this story, the outlaw Silky Bob has come home to reunite with his friend Jimmy Wells after 20 years. Their reunion is bittersweet, though, since Jimmy - now a patrolman whom Bob unwittingly meets - sends a plainclothesman to arrest his old friend whom he recognized as a fugitive.

THEME

Henry's short story 'After Twenty Years' focuses on the reunion of two old friends: Jimmy and Bob. Through their brief encounter, the two explore the themes of friendship, loyalty, and trust. Bob's punctuality in keeping his meeting with Jimmy perhaps best demonstrates his loyalty to their friendship.

UELS 201

ENGLISH LANGUAGE
SKILLS – II

In the Bazaars of Hyderabad

SAROJINI NAIDU

What do you sell O ye merchants?
Richly your wares are displayed.
Turbans of crimson and silver,
Tunics of purple brocade,
Mirrors with panels of amber,
Daggers with handles of jade.

What do you weigh, O ye vendors?
Saffron and lentil and rice.
What do you grind, O ye maidens?
Sandalwood, henna, and spice.
What do you call, O ye pedlars?
Chessmen and ivory dice.

What do you make, O ye goldsmiths?
Wristlet and anklet and ring,
Bells for the feet of blue pigeons
Frail as a dragon-fly's wing,
Girdles of gold for dancers,
Scabbards of gold for the king.

What do you cry, O ye fruitmen?
Citron, pomegranate, and plum.
What do you play, O musicians?
Cithar, sarangi and drum.
What do you chant, O magicians?
Spells for aeons to come.

What do you weave, O ye flower-girls
With tassels of azure and red?
Crowns for the brow of a bridegroom,
Chaplets to garland his bed.
Sheets of white blossoms new-garnered
To perfume the sleep of the dead.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Sarojini Naidu was a political activist, poet, and supporter of Indian independence. She goes by the name 'The Nightingale of India,' and she is a well-known orator and poet. Naidu was a gifted young author who won a scholarship to study abroad for her play

'Maher Muneer' when she was just a young girl. She was elected as the Indian National Congress' second female president. She was an Indian state's first female governor following the country's independence.

Sarojini Naidu is admired for her work in Indian poetry in addition to her role and commitment to the Indian Nationalist Movement. Songs have been made from several of her compositions. She found inspiration in nature and the world around her, and the spirit of her patriotism was reflected in her writing. Her collection of poems, titled "Golden Threshold," was released in 1905. She later released two additional volumes, "The Bird of Time" and "The Broken Wings," which were both very well received in both India and England. In addition to poetry, she also wrote essays and articles like "Words of Freedom" on social concerns like women's empowerment and political difficulties.

SUMMARY

In this poem, Naidu describes the beauty of traditional Hyderabad bazaars. She presented the lively picturesque scenes of merchants, vendors, peddlers, goldsmiths, fruit men, and flower girls selling their goods, all of whom answer the questions of purchasers who buy their articles after meticulous chaffering.

THEME

'In the Bazaars of Hyderabad' was a part of the Swadeshi Movement, an Indian freedom movement. The poet wanted to deliver the message that the traditional Indian products made of pure materials were of very high quality. Folklore is also a central subject in 'The Bazaars of Hyderabad.' It is associated with one such subject, the charm and enthusiasm of a traditional bazaar in the city of Hyderabad is introduced in this poem.

Excerpt from “Self-Reliance”

RALPH WALDO EMERSON

Society never advances. It recedes as fast on one side as it gains on the other. It undergoes continual changes; it is barbarous, it is civilized, it is christianized, it is rich, it is scientific; but this change is not amelioration. For everything that is given, something is taken. Society acquires new arts, and loses old instincts. What a contrast between the well-clad, reading, writing, thinking American, with a watch, a pencil, and a bill of exchange in his pocket, and the naked New Zealander, whose property is a club, a spear, a mat, and an undivided twentieth of a shed to sleep under! But compare the health of the two men, and you shall see that the white man has lost his aboriginal strength. If the traveller tell us truly, strike the savage with a broad axe, and in a day or two the flesh shall unite and heal as if you struck the blow into soft pitch, and the same blow shall send the white to his grave.

The civilized man has built a coach, but has lost the use of his feet. He is supported on crutches, but lacks so much support of muscle. He has a fine Geneva watch, but he fails of the skill to tell the hour by the sun. A Greenwich nautical almanac he has, and so being sure of the information when he wants it, the man in the street does not know a star in the sky. The solstice he does not observe; the equinox he knows as little; and the whole bright calendar of the year is without a dial in his mind. His note-books impair his memory; his libraries overload his wit; the insurance-office increases the number of accidents; and it may be a question whether machinery does not encumber; whether we have not lost by refinement some energy, by a Christianity entrenched in establishments and forms, some vigor of wild virtue. For every Stoic was a Stoic; but in Christendom where is the Christian?

There is no more deviation in the moral standard than in the standard of height or bulk. No greater men are now than ever were. A singular equality may be observed between the great men of the first and of the last ages; nor can all the science, art, religion, and philosophy of the nineteenth century avail to educate greater men than Plutarch's heroes, three or four and twenty centuries ago. Not in time is the race progressive. Phocion,

Socrates, Anaxagoras, Diogenes, are great men, but they leave no class. He who is really of their class will not be called by their name, but will be his own man, and, in his turn, the founder of a sect. The arts and inventions of each period are only its costume, and do not invigorate men. The harm of the improved machinery may compensate its good. Hudson and Behring accomplished so much in their fishing-boats, as to astonish Parry and Franklin, whose equipment exhausted the resources of science and art. Galileo, with an opera-glass, discovered a more splendid series of celestial phenomena than any one since. Columbus found the New World in an undecked boat. It is curious to see the periodical disuse and perishing of means and machinery, which were introduced with loud laudation a few years or centuries before. The great genius returns to essential man. We reckoned the improvements of the art of war among the triumphs of science, and yet Napoleon conquered Europe by the bivouac, which consisted of falling back on naked valor, and disencumbering it of all aids. The Emperor held it impossible to make a perfect army, says Las Casas, without abolishing our arms, magazines, commissaries, and carriages, until, in imitation of the Roman custom, the soldier should receive his supply of corn, grind it in his hand-mill, and bake his bread himself.

Society is a wave. The wave moves onward, but the water of which it is composed does not. The same particle does not rise from the valley to the ridge. Its unity is only phenomenal. The persons who make up a nation to-day, next year die, and their experience with them.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

The provided text is an excerpt from the essay "Self-Reliance" by Ralph Waldo Emerson, a prominent American essayist, philosopher, and poet. Born on May 25, 1803, in Boston, Massachusetts, Emerson emerged as a leading figure in the transcendentalist movement during the mid-19th century. Transcendentalism was a philosophical and literary movement that emphasized individual intuition, spirituality, and the inherent goodness of people. Emerson's essays, including "Self-Reliance," are known for their exploration of individualism, nonconformity, and the rejection of societal norms. He encouraged readers to trust their own instincts, embrace independence, and resist conformity to external expectations. Emerson's work had a profound influence on American literature and thought, shaping the intellectual landscape of his time.

In addition to his essays, Emerson was a gifted poet and lecturer. Some of his other notable works include "Nature," "The American Scholar," and "Essays: First Series" and "Essays: Second Series." He was a key figure in the Transcendentalist Club, a group of intellectuals that included Henry David Thoreau and Margaret Fuller. Ralph Waldo Emerson's ideas on self-reliance, individualism, and the transcendent nature of the human spirit continue to resonate and inspire readers today. His contributions have left a lasting impact on American philosophy and literature, making him a central figure in the cultural and intellectual history of the United States. Emerson passed away on April 27, 1882, but his legacy endures through his writings and their ongoing influence on the exploration of the human experience.

ABOUT THE TEXT

The provided text is an excerpt from Ralph Waldo Emerson's essay "Self-Reliance." In this essay, Emerson explains that people must believe in their own intuition and reject the opinions of others in order to transcend the bounds of the physical world. He also explores the idea that societal progress is not a straightforward improvement, but rather a cyclical process with gains and losses. He argues against blind conformity to societal norms and emphasizes the importance of individual intuition, self-trust, and independence. The text critiques the impact of civilization on human abilities, suggesting that material advancements may come at the cost of losing innate strengths and skills. Emerson challenges the concept of moral progress and concludes by highlighting the transient nature of individual experiences in the continuous movement of society. The essay is a key work in the transcendentalist movement and reflects Emerson's belief in the importance of self-reliance and nonconformity.

The Three Questions

LEO TOLSTOY

IT ONCE OCCURRED to a certain king, that if he always knew the right time to begin everything; if he knew who were the right people to listen to, and whom to avoid, and, above all, if he always knew what was the most important thing to do, he would never fail in anything he might undertake.

And this thought having occurred to him, he had it proclaimed throughout his kingdom that he would give a great reward to anyone who would teach him what was the right time for every action, and who were the most necessary people, and how he might know what was the most important thing to do.

And learned men came to the king, but they all answered his questions differently.

In reply to the first question, some said that to know the right time for every action, one must draw up in advance, a table of days, months and years, and must live strictly according to it. Only thus, said they, could everything be done at its proper time. Others declared that it was impossible to decide beforehand the right time for every action; but that, not letting oneself be absorbed in idle pastimes, one should always attend to all that was going on, and then do what was most needful. Others, again, said that however attentive the king might be to what was going on, it was impossible for one man to decide correctly the right time for every action, but that he should have a Council of wise men, who would help him to fix the proper time for everything.

But then again others said there were some things which could not wait to be laid before a Council, but about which one had at once to decide whether to undertake them or not. But in order to decide that one must know beforehand what was going to happen. It is only magicians who know that; and, therefore in order to know the right time for every action, one must consult magicians.

Equally various were the answers to the second question. Some said, the people the king most needed were his councilors; others, the priests; others, the doctors; while some said the warriors were the most necessary.

To the third question, as to what was the most important occupation: some replied that the most important thing in the world was science. Others said it was skill in warfare; and others, again, that it was religious worship.

All the answers being different, the king agreed with none of them, and gave the reward to none. But still wishing to find the right answers to his questions, he decided to consult a hermit, widely renowned for his wisdom.

The hermit lived in a wood which he never quitted and he received none but common folk. So the king put on simple clothes, and before reaching the hermit's cell dismounted from his horse, and, leaving his bodyguard behind, went on alone.

When the king approached, the hermit was digging the ground in front of his hut. Seeing the king, he greeted him and went on digging. The hermit was frail and weak, and each time he stuck his spade into the ground and turned a little earth, he breathed heavily.

The king went up to him and said: I have come to you, wise hermit, to ask you to answer three questions: How can I learn to do the right thing at the right time? Who are the people I most need, and to whom should I, therefore, pay more attention than to the rest? And, what affairs are the most important and need my first attention?

The hermit listened to the king, but answered nothing. He just spat on his hand and recommenced digging.

You are tired, said the king, let me take the spade and work awhile for you.

Thanks! said the hermit, and, giving the spade to the king, he sat down on the ground.

When he had dug two beds, the king stopped and repeated his questions. The hermit again gave no answer, but rose, stretched out his hand for the spade, and said:

Now rest awhile — and let me work a bit.

But the king did not give him the spade, and continued to dig. One hour passed, and another. The sun began to sink behind the trees, and the king at last stuck the spade into the ground, and said:

I came to you, wise man, for an answer to my questions. If you can give me none, tell me so, and I will return home.

Here comes someone running, said the hermit, let us see who it is.

The king turned round, and saw a bearded man come running out of the wood. The man held his hands pressed against his stomach, and blood was flowing from under them. When he reached the king, he fell fainting on the ground moaning feebly. The king and the hermit unfastened the man's clothing. There was a large wound in his stomach. The king washed it as best he could, and bandaged it with his handkerchief and with a towel the hermit had. But the blood would not stop flowing, and the king again and again removed the bandage soaked with warm blood, and washed and rebandaged the wound. When at last the blood ceased flowing, the man revived and asked for something to drink. The king brought fresh water and gave it to him. Meanwhile the sun had set, and it had become cool. So the king, with the hermit's help, carried the wounded man into the hut and laid him on the bed. Lying on the bed the man closed his eyes and was quiet; but the king was so tired with his walk and with the work he had done, that he crouched down on the threshold, and also fell asleep — so soundly that he slept all through the short summer night.

When he awoke in the morning, it was long before he could remember where he was, or who was the strange bearded man lying on the bed and gazing intently at him with shining eyes.

Forgive me! said the bearded man in a weak voice, when he saw that the king was awake and was looking at him.

I do not know you, and have nothing to forgive you for, said the king.

You do not know me, but I know you. I am that enemy of yours who swore to revenge himself on you, because you executed his brother and seized his property. I knew you had gone alone to see the hermit, and I resolved to kill you on your way back. But the day passed and you did not return. So I came out from my ambush to find you, and I came upon your bodyguard, and they recognized me, and wounded me. I escaped from them, but should have bled to death had you not dressed my wound. I wished to kill you, and you have saved my life. Now, if I live, and if you wish it, I will serve you as your most faithful slave, and will bid my sons do the same. Forgive me!

The king was very glad to have made peace with his enemy so easily, and to have gained him for a friend, and he not only forgave him, but said he would send his servants and his own physician to attend him, and promised to restore his property.

Having taken leave of the wounded man, the king went out into the porch and looked around for the hermit. Before going away he wished once more to beg an answer to the questions he had put. The hermit was outside, on his knees, sowing seeds in the beds that had been dug the day before.

The king approached him, and said: For the last time, I pray you to answer my questions, wise man.

You have already been answered! said the hermit still crouching on his thin legs, and looking up at the king, who stood before him.

How answered? What do you mean? asked the king.

Do you not see, replied the hermit. If you had not pitied my weakness yesterday, and had not dug these beds for me, but had gone your way, that man would have attacked you, and you would have repented of not having stayed with me. So the most important time was when you were digging the beds; and I was the most important man; and to do me good was your most important business. Afterwards, when that man ran to us, the most important time was when you were attending to him, for if you had not bound up his wounds, he would have died without having made peace with you. So he was the most important man, and what you did for him was your most important business. Remember then: there is only one time that is important — Now! It is the most important time because it is the only time when we have any power. The most necessary man is he with whom you are, for no man knows whether he will ever have dealings with anyone else: and the most important affair is, to do him good, because for that purpose alone was man sent into this life!

ABOUT THE AUTHOR:

The provided text is a short story titled "The Three Questions" by the renowned Russian author Leo Tolstoy. Born on September 9, 1828, Tolstoy was a prolific writer, essayist, and philosopher, widely regarded as one of the greatest novelists in world literature. His literary masterpieces, such as "War and Peace" and "Anna Karenina," are celebrated for their exploration of human nature, morality, and social issues. Tolstoy's writing reflects his philosophical and spiritual inquiries, as he delved into questions of life's purpose, morality, and the nature of existence. Later in his life, Tolstoy embraced a form of Christian anarchism and rejected the material wealth he had inherited, choosing a simpler and more ascetic lifestyle. Leo Tolstoy's influence extends far beyond his literary contributions. His philosophical ideas and reflections on life have inspired readers and thinkers around the world.

"The Three Questions" is one of Tolstoy's short stories that conveys profound moral and philosophical lessons. In this tale, Tolstoy explores themes of kindness, compassion, and the significance of the present moment. The narrative style and moral undertones in this story are characteristic of Tolstoy's broader body of work.

"The Three Questions" by Leo Tolstoy is a philosophical and moral short story that explores essential questions about life and conduct. The narrative revolves around a king seeking answers to three fundamental questions: the right time for every action, the most necessary people, and the most important business. The king consults various learned individuals, receiving conflicting answers.

Ultimately, he turns to a wise hermit for guidance. The hermit, engaged in simple tasks like digging, does not provide direct answers but involves the king in his work. During their activities, a wounded man arrives, and the king selflessly tends to him, revealing compassion and kindness. The story concludes with the hermit's wisdom that the most important time is "Now" and underscores the significance of helping others in the present moment.

SUMMARY

The Three Questions by Leo Tolstoy is a story about a king, who had three questions always in his mind that were what was the right time for every action, who were the most necessary people, and third question was how he might know what was the most important thing to do.

THEME

The three questions were asked by the wise hermit to the king. The message of this story was the true purpose of life is to help others. The best time to live life is in the present time. This story deals with the theme of wisdom, kindness, acceptance, and forgiveness.

UELS-201
NON-DETAILED TEXT
Selections from *India's Greatest Speeches*
compiled by Nitin Agarwal

Statement Before the Lahore High Court Bench

BHAGAT SINGH

MY LORDS,

We are neither lawyers nor masters of English language, nor holders of degrees. Therefore, please do not expect any oratorical speech from us. We therefore pray that instead of going into the language mistakes of our statement Your Lordships will try to understand the real sense of it.

Leaving other points to our lawyers, I will confine myself to one point only. The point is very important in this case. The point is as to what were our intentions and to what extent we are guilty. This is a very complicated question and no one will be able to express before you that height of mental elevation which inspired us to think and act in a particular manner. We want that this should be kept in mind while assessing our intentions and our offence. According to the famous jurist Solomon, one should not be punished for his criminal offence if his aim is not against law.

We had submitted a written statement in the Sessions Court. That statement explains our aim and, as such, explains our intentions also. But the learned judge dismissed it with one stroke of pen, saying that "generally the operation of law is not affected by how or why one committed the offence. In this country the aim of the offence is very rarely mentioned in legal commentaries."

My Lords, our contention is that under the circumstances the learned judge ought to have judged us either by the result of our action or on the basis of the psychological part of our statement. But he did not take any of these factors into consideration.

The point to be considered is that the two bombs we threw in the Assembly did not harm anybody physically or economically. As such the punishment awarded to us is not only very harsh but revengeful also. Moreover, the motive knowing his psychology. And no one can do justice to anybody without taking his motive into consideration. If we ignore the motive, the biggest general of the words will appear like ordinary murderers; revenue officers will look like thieves and cheats. Even judges will be accused of murder. This way the entire social system and the civilization will be reduced to murders, thefts and cheating. If we ignore the motive, the government will have no right to expect sacrifice from its people and its officials. Ignore the motive and every religious preacher will be dubbed as a preacher of falsehoods, and every prophet will be charged of misguiding crores of simple and ignorant people.

If we set aside the motive, then Jesus Christ will appear to be a man responsible for creating disturbances, breaking peace and preaching revolt, and will be considered to be a "dangerous personality" in the language of the law. But we worship him. He commands great respect in our hearts and his image creates vibrations of spiritualism amongst us. Why? Because the inspiration behind his actions was that of a high ideal. The rulers of that age could not recognize that high idealism. They only saw his outward actions. Nineteen centuries have passed since then. Have we not progressed during this period? Shall we repeat that mistake again? If that be so, then we shall have to admit that all the sacrifices of the mankind and all the efforts of the great martyrs were useless and it would appear as if we are still at the same place where we stood twenty centuries back.

From the legal point of view also, the question of motive is of special importance. Take the example of General Dyer. He resorted to firing and killed hundreds of innocent and unarmed people. But the military court did not order him to be shot. It gave him lakhs of rupees as award. Take another example. Shri Kharag Bahadur Singh, a young Gurkha, Killed a Marwari in Calcutta. If the motive be set aside, then Kharag Bahadur Singh ought to have been hanged. But he was awarded a mild sentence of a few years only. He was even released much before the expiry of his sentence. Was there any loophole in the law that he escaped capital punishment? Or, was the charge of murder not proved against him? Like us, he also accepted the full responsibility of his action, but he escaped death. He is free today. I ask Your Lordship, why was he not awarded capital punishment? His action was well calculated and well planned. From the motive end, his action was more serious and fatal than ours. He was awarded a mild punishment because his intentions were good. He was awarded a mild punishment because his intention were good. He saved the society from a dirty leach who had sucked the life-blood of so many pretty young girls. Kharag Singh was given a mild punishment just to uphold the formalities of the law.

This principle (that the law does not take motive into consideration - ed.) is quite absurd. This is against the basic principles of the law which declares that "the law is for man and not man for the law". As such, why the same norms are not being applied to us also? It is quite clear that while convicting Kharag Singh his motive was kept in mind, otherwise a murderer can never escape the hangman's noose. Are we being deprived of the ordinary advantage of the law because our offence is against the government, or because our action has a political importance?

My Lords, under these circumstances, please permit us to assert that a government which seeks shelter behind such mean methods has no right to exist. If it exists, it is for the time being only, and that too with the blood of thousands of people on its head. If the law does not see the motive there can be no justice, nor can there be stable peace.

Mixing of arsenic (poison) in the flour will not be considered to be a crime, provided its purpose is to kill rats. But if the purpose is to kill a man, it becomes a crime of murder.

Therefore, such laws which do not stand the test of reason and which are against the principle of justice, should be abolished. Because of such unjust laws, many great intellectuals had to adopt the path of revolt.

The facts regarding our case are very simple. We threw two bombs in the legislative Assembly on April 8, 1929. As a result of the explosion, a few persons received minor scratches. There was pandemonium in the chamber, hundreds of visitors and members of the Assembly ran out. Only my friend B.K. Dutt and myself remained seated in the visitors gallery and offered ourselves for arrest. We were tried for attempt to murder, and convicted for life. As mentioned above, as a result of the bomb explosion, only four or five persons were slightly injured and one bench got damaged. We offered ourselves for arrest without any resistance. The Sessions Judge admitted that we could have very easily escaped, had we had any intention like that. We accepted our offence and gave a statement explaining our position. We are not afraid of punishment. But we do not want that we should be wrongly understood. The judge removed a few paragraphs from our statement. This we consider to be harmful for our real position.

A proper study of the full text of our statement will make it clear that, according to us, our country is passing through a delicate phase. We saw the coming catastrophe and thought it proper to give a timely warning with a loud voice, and we gave the warning in the manner we thought proper. We may be wrong. Our line of thinking and that of the learned judge may be different, but that does not mean that we be deprived of the permission to express our ideas, and wrong things be propagated in our name.

In our statement we explained in detail what we mean by "Long Live Revolution" and "Down With Imperialism". That formed the crux of our ideas. That portion was removed from our statement. Generally a wrong meaning is attributed to the word revolution. That is not our understanding. Bombs and pistols do not make revolution. That is not our understanding. Bombs and pistols do not make revolution. The sword of revolution is sharpened on the whetting-stone of ideas. This is what we wanted to emphasize. By revolution we mean the end of the miseries of capitalist wars. It was not proper to pronounce judgment without understanding our aims and objects and the process of achieving them. To associate wrong ideas with our names is out and out injustice.

It was very necessary to give the timely warning that the unrest of the people is increasing and that the malady may take a serious turn, if not treated in time and properly. If our warning is not heeded, no human power will be able to stop it. We took this step to give proper direction to the storm. We are serious students of history. We believe that, had the ruling powers acted correctly at the proper time, there would have been no bloody revolutions in France and Russia. Several big power of the world tried to check the storm of ideas and were sunk in the atmosphere of bloodshed. The ruling people cannot change

the flow of the current. We wanted to give the first warning. Had we aimed at killing some important personalities, we would have failed in the attainment of our aim.

My Lords, this was the aim and the spirit behind our action, and the result of the action corroborates our statement. There is one more point which needs elucidation, and that is regarding the strength of the bombs. Had we had no idea of the strength of the bombs, there would have been no question of our throwing them in the presence of our respected national leader like Pandit Motilal Nehru, Shri Kelkar, Shri Jayaker and Shri Jinnah. How could we have risked the lives of our leaders? After all we are not mad and, had we been so, we would have certainly been sent to the lunatic asylum, instead of being put in jail. We had full knowledge about the strength of the bombs and that is why we acted with so much confidence. It was very easy to have thrown the bombs on the occupied benches, but it was difficult to have thrown them on unoccupied seats. Had we not of saner mind or had we been mentally unbalanced, the bombs would have fallen on occupied benches and not in empty places. Therefore I would say that we should be rewarded for the courage we showed in carefully selecting the empty places. Under these conditions, My Lords, we think we have not been understood, My Lords, we think we have not been understood properly. We have not come before you to get our sentences reduced. We have come here to clarify our position. We want that we should not be given any unjust treatment, nor should any unjust opinion be pronounced about us. The question of punishment is of secondary importance before us.

ABOUT THE TEXT

Bhagat Singh is considered one of the important national heroes of the freedom struggle against the British government. On 8th April 1929 he, along with B.K Dutt, surrendered to be arrested after hurling bombs at the Central State Assembly situated in the Central Delhi district of the National Capital Territory of Delhi. His statement before the Lahore High Court Bench considering this incident is of utmost importance. Through his statement, Bhagat Singh laid down the 'motive of action' and argued that the motive should be the prime consideration while judging the criminal liability of an accused in the court. He contended that the Sessions Court should have judged the accused either by the result of their actions or on the psychological part of their statement but the court did not take these factors into consideration. He argued how the bombs they threw did not result in loss of lives or materials and their intent was solely 'to make the deaf hear'. Bhagat Singh's statement before the Lahore High Court highlights the significance of the motive of the actions. He was not just a freedom fighter but an ideal that continues to inspire generations to stand against injustices.

Through this brilliant statement Bhagat Singh demolished the basis of the Sessions Court judgment and emphasized the importance of motive. The motive of action, he argued, should be the main consideration while judging the offence of an accused.

Mother Teresa

Acceptance Speech (1979)

Let us all together thank God for this beautiful occasion where we can all together proclaim the joy of spreading peace, the joy of loving one another and the joy acknowledging that the poorest of the poor are our brothers and sisters.

As we have gathered here to thank God for this gift of peace, I have given you all the prayer for peace that St Francis of Assisi prayed many years ago, and I wonder he must have felt the need what we feel today to pray for. I think you have all got that paper? We ll say it together.

Lord, make me a channel of your peace, that where there is hatred, I may bring love; that where there is wrong, I may bring the spirit of forgiveness; that where there is discord, I may bring harmony; that where there is error, I may bring truth; that where there is doubt, I may bring faith; that where there is despair, I may bring hope; that where there are shadows, I may bring light; that where there is sadness, I may bring joy.

Lord, grant that I may seek rather to comfort than to be comforted; to understand, than to be understood; to love, than to be loved. For it is by forgetting self, that one finds. It is by forgiving that one is forgiven. It is by dying, that one awakens to eternal life. Amen.

God loved the world so much that he gave his son and he gave him to a virgin, the blessed virgin Mary, and she, the moment he came in her life, went in haste to give him to others. And what did she do then? She did the work of the handmaid, just so. Just spread that joy of loving to service. And Jesus Christ loved you and loved me and he gave his life for us, and as if that was not enough for him, he kept on saying: Love as I have loved you, as I love you now, and how do we have to love, to love in the giving. For he gave his life for us. And he keeps on giving, and he keeps on giving right here everywhere in our own lives and in the lives of others.

It was not enough for him to die for us, he wanted that we loved one another, that we see him in each other, that's why he said: Blessed are the clean of heart, for they shall see God.

And to make sure that we understand what he means, he said that at the hour of death we are going to be judged on what we have been to the poor, to the hungry, naked, the homeless, and he makes himself that hungry one, that naked one, that homeless one, not only hungry for bread, but hungry for love, not only naked for a piece of cloth, but naked of that human dignity, not only homeless for a room to live, but homeless for that being forgotten, been unloved, uncared, being nobody to nobody, having forgotten what is

human love, what is human touch, what is to be loved by somebody, and he says: Whatever you did to the least of these my brethren, you did it to me.

It is so beautiful for us to become holy to this love, for holiness is not a luxury of the few, it is a simple duty for each one of us, and through this love we can become holy. To this love for one another and today when I have received this reward, I personally am most unworthy, and I having avowed poverty to be able to understand the poor, I choose the poverty of our people. But I am grateful and I am very happy to receive it in the name of the hungry, of the naked, of the homeless, of the crippled, of the blind, of the leprous, of all those people who feel unwanted, unloved, uncared, thrown away of the society, people who have become a burden to the society, and are ashamed by everybody.

In their name I accept the award. And I am sure this award is going to bring an understanding love between the rich and the poor. And this is what Jesus has insisted so much, that is why Jesus came to earth, to proclaim the good news to the poor. And through this award and through all of us gathered here together, we are wanting to proclaim the good news to the poor that God loves them, that we love them, that they are somebody to us, that they too have been created by the same loving hand of God, to love and to be loved. Our poor people are great people, are very lovable people, they don't need our pity and sympathy, they need our understanding love. They need our respect; they need that we treat them with dignity. And I think this is the greatest poverty that we experience, that we have in front of them who may be dying for a piece of bread, but they die to such dignity. I never forget when I brought a man from the street. He was covered with maggots; his face was the only place that was clean. And yet that man, when we brought him to our home for the dying, he said just one sentence: I have lived like an animal in the street, but I am going to die like an angel, love and care, and he died beautifully. He went home to God, for dead is nothing but going home to God. And he having enjoyed that love, that being wanted, that being loved, that being somebody to somebody at the last moment, brought that joy in his life.

And I feel one thing I want to share with you all, the greatest destroyer of peace today is the cry of the innocent unborn child. For if a mother can murder her own child in her own womb, what is left for you and for me to kill each other? Even in the scripture it is written: Even if mother could forget her child – I will not forget you – I have carved you in the palm of my hand. Even if mother could forget, but today millions of unborn children are being killed. And we say nothing. In the newspapers you read numbers of this one and that one being killed, this being destroyed, but nobody speaks of the millions of little ones who have been conceived to the same life as you and I, to the life of God, and we say nothing, we allow it. To me the nations who have legalized abortion, they are the poorest nations. They are afraid of the little one, they are afraid of the unborn child, and the child must die because they don't want to feed one more child, to educate one more child, the child must die.

And here I ask you, in the name of these little ones, for it was that unborn child that recognized the presence of Jesus when Mary came to visit Elizabeth, her cousin. As we read in the gospel, the moment Mary came into the house, the little one in the womb of his mother, leapt with joy, recognized the Prince of Peace. And so today, let us here make a strong resolution, we are going to save every little child, every unborn child, give them a chance to be born. And what we are doing, we are fighting abortion by adoption, and the good God has blessed the work so beautifully that we have saved thousands of children, and thousands of children have found a home where they are loved, they are wanted, they are cared. We have brought so much joy in the homes that there was not a child, and so today, I ask His Majesties here before you all who come from different countries, let us all pray that we have the courage to stand by the unborn child, and give the child an opportunity to love and to be loved, and I think with God's grace we will be able to bring peace in the world. We have an opportunity here in Norway, you are with God's blessing, you are well to do. But I am sure in the families and many of our homes, maybe we are not hungry for a piece of bread, but maybe there is somebody there in the family who is unwanted, unloved, uncared, forgotten, there isn't love. Love begins at home. And love to be true has to hurt. I never forget a little child who taught me a very beautiful lesson. They heard in Calcutta, the children, that Mother Teresa had no sugar for her children, and this little one, Hindu boy four years old, he went home and he told his parents: I will not eat sugar for three days, I will give my sugar to Mother Teresa. How much a little child can give. After three days they brought into our house, and there was this little one who could scarcely pronounce my name, he loved with great love, he loved until it hurt. And this is what I bring before you, to love one another until it hurts, but don't forget that there are many children, many children, many men and women who haven't got what you have. And remember to love them until it hurts. Sometime ago, this to you will sound very strange, but I brought a girl child from the street, and I could see in the face of the child that the child was hungry. God knows how many days that she had not eaten. So I give her a piece of bread. And then the little one started eating the bread crumb by crumb. And I said to the child, eat the bread, eat the bread. And she looked at me and said: I am afraid to eat the bread because I'm afraid when it is finished I will be hungry again. This is a reality, and yet there is a greatness of the poor. One evening a gentleman came to our house and said, there is a Hindu family and the eight children have not eaten for a long time. Do something for them. And I took rice and I went immediately, and there was this mother, those little ones' faces, shining eyes from sheer hunger. She took the rice from my hand, she divided into two and she went out. When she came back, I asked her, where did you go? What did you do? And one answer she gave me: They are hungry also. She knew that the next door neighbor, a Muslim family, was hungry.

What surprised me most, not that she gave the rice, but what surprised me most, that in her suffering, in her hunger, she knew that somebody else was hungry, and she had the courage to share, share the love. And this is what I mean, I want you to love the poor, and

never turn your back to the poor, for in turning your back to the poor, you are turning it to Christ. For he had made himself the hungry one, the naked one, the homeless one, so that you and I have an opportunity to love him, because where is God? How can we love God? It is not enough to say to my God I love you, but my God, I love you here. I can enjoy this, but I give up. I could eat that sugar, but I give that sugar. If I stay here the whole day and the whole night, you would be surprised of the beautiful things that people do, to share the joy of giving. And so, my prayer for you is that truth will bring prayer in our homes, and the fruit of prayer will be that we believe that in the poor, it is Christ. And if we really believe, we will begin to love. And if we love, naturally, we will try to do something. First in our own home, our next door neighbor, in the country we live, in the whole world. And let us all join in that one prayer, God give us courage to protect the unborn child, for the child is the greatest gift of God to a family, to a nation and to the whole world. God bless you!

ABOUT THE TEXT

In 1979, Mother Teresa delivered an inspiring speech to the world after receiving the Nobel Prize. She eloquently discussed her journey to find peace through service to the world's poor and downtrodden. The speech served as a masterclass in authenticity and humility, brilliantly reflecting her life-long beliefs and values.

The speech reflected what she believed and was consistent with how she lived her life, due to its heartfelt tone and authenticity. Here's what great communicators can learn from this great spirit.

A Farewell to Cricket

Sachin Tendulkar's goodbye speech (2013)

All my friends, settle down let me talk, I'll get more and more emotional.

My life between 22 yards in the 24 years, it's hard to believe that it's coming to an end. I would like to thank all the people who have helped me in my life to get here. I have a list in my hand, please forgive me if I miss out on a few names.

First, the most important person in my life, my father. He passed away in 1999. He was key for my career. He gave me freedom at the age of 11 and told me, chase your dreams and don't find shortcuts. He also told me to be a nice human being, which I am still trying my best to be.

My mother, I don't know how she dealt with a naughty child like me. She took care of me to be healthy. She started praying for me even before I started my career and I think those prayers gave my strength.

In my school days, I used to stay with my uncle and aunt as my school was far away. They treated me like their son. When after a hard day's cricket, I went home, I was half asleep. My aunt fed me so that I could go and play the next day.

My eldest brother, Nitin. He doesn't like to talk much but he used to tell me, I know you'd do everything right and I have the confidence in you. My sister, she gave me my first bat. A Kashmir Willow bat. She continues to fast when I bat.

Ajit, I don't know what I should say about him. We have lived this dream together. It all started from the age of 11, when he took me to Achrekar sir my coach. He saw a spark in me and sacrificed his career for mine. And my life changed. Even last night, he called me and we were discussing my dismissal. We've had so many discussions and arguments. Various things we agreed upon and at times, when he said something about my technique, I didn't agree with him. If I had not done that, I would have been a lesser cricketer.

The most important thing happened to me in 1990 when I met my wife Anjali. I knew she was a doctor and had a wonderful career ahead of her. But when we decided to make a family, she said, 'you continue with your cricket and I'll take care of the family'. Without

that I think I couldn't have played so much cricket. Thank you for bearing with my fuss, frustration and all the nonsense I have said over the years. This is the best partnership I've had in my life.

Then Sara and Arjun – the two precious diamonds in my life. My daughter is 16 and son is 14, time has flown by. I wasn't able to be with them for the birthdays, annual days and sports days. Thanks for understanding all that, both of you have been so special to me. I've not spent enough time with you but I promise you the next 16 years or even more, are all for you.

My in-laws have been supporting. I discuss various things with them, we have a strong family and I thank you for allowing me to marry Anjali.

My career started at 11. My brother took me to Achrekar sir and that is the best thing to have happened to me. Sir would be taking me on his scooter all over Mumbai, from Shivaji Park to Azad Maidan to ensure that I get enough match practice.

On a lighter note, he's never said 'well played' to me so that I don't get complacent. Sir, you can push your luck now that I don't have any more matches to play.

In the last 24 yrs, I made new friends, before that I had friends from childhood. Whenever I have called them to bowl to me on nets, they have left all their work aside to be with me. Even when I was injured, they were beside me. That's when my friends have woken up at 3 in the morning just to make me believe that my career is not over yet. Life would have been incomplete without them. Thanks for being there.

My cricket started right here at this ground for Mumbai. I remember once landing from New Zealand at 4 am and playing a Ranji Trophy match at 8 am. It wasn't that anyone forced me to do so. I played because of my love for Mumbai Cricket. The Mumbai Cricket Association has been very supportive.

The dream was obviously to play for India. BCCI was fantastic, they believed in me at the age of 16 years and selected me. Thanks for the support and the freedom to express myself in the middle. Whenever I was injured, the BCCI ensured all my treatments are taken care of so I could be fit and play again.

I have played with many senior cricketers, thanks to everyone for helping me out. I see Rahul (Dravid), VVS (Laxman) and Sourav (Ganguly) on the big screen. Also, Anil

(Kumble) who is not here, and my teammates. You guys are like my family. It is going to be difficult without that dressing room, sharing those special moments.

When Dhoni gave me the 200th Test cap, I just said, we are all proud to be here as a team and I believe that you guys will continue to represent this country in the right spirit to the best of our abilities. I believe in you and all the best for your future.

I would be failing in my duty if I didn't thank all the doctors, physios, without whose special efforts, I couldn't have been fit. I don't know how you all kept me in good shape.

My dear friend, late Mark Mascarenhas, my first manager. We lost him in a car accident in 2002. He was very passionate about my game and importantly about Indian Cricket. He ensured my cricket never suffered because of the shoots and other commitments with the sponsors. Without him I couldn't have achieved all this. I miss you. My current manager Vinod Naidu, he's more like my family. He's given me so much time, leaving his family to do my work.

In the school days when I played well, the media backed me a lot. You've been doing that till now. Thank you to all of you, all those photographers who captured those wonderful moments that will remain with me.

I thank all the people here who have traveled from different parts of the world to just watch me. You people have always supported me whether I scored a 0 or a 100. I've met a lot of people who fast for me, pray for me and do all sorts of things for me. I thank you for all that you've done.

Especially the 'Sachinnnn... Sachin.' Chants. It will reverberate in my ears until my last breath. Thank you very much. I am sorry if I have missed out on anything. Good bye.

ABOUT THE TEXT

Sachin delivered this emotional farewell speech at the Wankhede stadium in Mumbai on November 16, 2013. A billion and more fans were listening with rapt attention as Tendulkar, arguably the greatest Indian cricketer brought the curtains down on his celebrated 24-year-long career. One of the most important lessons from Sachin Tendulkar's Life is the ability of never giving up when things go wrong. Things can go wrong and you can suffer setbacks, whether it is in your studies or your career, however, you need to continue with your work and should not deviate from your goal. 5 things to learn from Sachin's life: Perseverance, Learning from mistakes, Focus, Humility, and Passion.

UELS 301

ENGLISH LANGUAGE
SKILLS - III

In a Library

EMILY DICKINSON

A precious, mouldering pleasure 't is
To meet an antique book,
In just the dress his century wore;
A privilege, I think,

His venerable hand to take,
And warming in our own,
A passage back, or two, to make
To times when he was young.

His quaint opinions to inspect,
His knowledge to unfold
On what concerns our mutual mind,
The literature of old;

What interested scholars most,
What competitions ran
When Plato was a certainty.
And Sophocles a man;

When Sappho was a living girl,
And Beatrice wore
The gown that Dante deified.
Facts, centuries before,

He traverses familiar,
As one should come to town
And tell you all your dreams were true;
He lived where dreams were sown.

His presence is enchantment,
You beg him not to go;
Old volumes shake their vellum heads
And tantalize, just so.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Emily Dickinson, the enigmatic poet of Amherst, Massachusetts, remains one of the most revered and influential figures in American literature. Born on December 10, 1830, Dickinson spent much of her life in relative seclusion, yet her poetry transcended the confines of her reclusive existence, offering profound insights into the human condition and the mysteries of existence. Dickinson's poetry, characterized by its brevity, elliptical language, and startling imagery, defies easy categorization. Her verses, often imbued with a sense of melancholy and longing, explore themes of love, death, nature, and the soul's journey, inviting readers into a world of profound introspection and existential inquiry.

Despite her unconventional approach to poetry, Dickinson's work possesses a timeless quality that continues to resonate with readers across generations. Her innovative use of form and syntax, as well as her bold experimentation with rhyme and meter, mark her as a pioneer of American poetry and a precursor to modernist literature. Throughout her life, Dickinson maintained a rich correspondence with family and friends, yet it was her poetry that served as her truest form of expression. Writing nearly 1,800 poems in total, Dickinson's oeuvre remained largely unknown during her lifetime, with only a handful of her poems published anonymously.

It was not until after her death on May 15, 1886, that Dickinson's remarkable literary legacy began to garner widespread recognition. Her sister, Lavinia, discovered her cache of poems and worked tirelessly to ensure their publication, bringing Dickinson's unique voice to the attention of the literary world. Dickinson's poetry is characterized by its keen observations of the natural world, its exploration of the inner landscape of the human psyche, and its unwavering commitment to truth and authenticity. Her verses, often characterized by their spare and economical language, possess a raw emotional power that speaks to the universal experience of love, loss, and longing.

SUMMARY

The setting of the poem *In a Library* is right in the title. The poem revolves around the many books that the speaker finds within a library and how they impact her. To meet an antique book, implies that it is not a book the speaker already owns.

THEME

In a Library by Emily Dickinson The poem *In a Library* was written by Emily Dickinson as an expression of her love of books, and the way they can transport her.

Joyfully I Write

RUSKIN BOND

I am a fortunate person. For over fifty years, I have been able to make a living by doing what I enjoy most—writing.

Sometimes I wonder if I have written too much. One gets into the habit of serving up the same ideas over and over again; with a different sauce perhaps, but still the same ideas, themes, memories, characters. Writers are often chided for repeating themselves. Artists and musicians are given more latitude. No one criticized Turner for painting so many sunsets at sea, or Gauguin for giving us all those lovely Tahitian women; or Husain for treating us to so many horses, or Jamini Roy for giving us so many identical stylized figures.

In the world of music, one Puccini opera is very like another, a Chopin nocturne will return to familiar themes, and in the realm of lighter, modern music, the same melodies recur with only slight variations. But authors are often taken to task for repeating themselves. They cannot help this, for in their writing they are expressing their personalities. Hemingway's world is very different from Jane Austen's. They are both unique worlds, but they do not change or mutate in the minds of their author-creators. Jane Austen spent all her life in one small place, and portrayed the people she knew. Hemingway roamed the world, but his characters remained much the same, usually extensions of himself.

In the course of a long writing career, it is inevitable that a writer will occasionally repeat himself, or return to themes that have remained with him even as new ideas and formulations enter his mind. The important thing is to keep writing, observing, listening, and paying attention to the beauty of words and their arrangement. And like artists and musicians, the more we work on our art, the better it will be.

Writing, for me, is the simplest and greatest pleasure in the world. Putting a mood or an idea into words is an occupation I truly love. I plan my day so that there is time in it for writing a poem, or a paragraph, or an essay, or part of a story or longer work; not just because writing is my profession, but from a feeling of delight.

The world around me—be it the mountains or the busy street below my window—is teeming with subjects, sights, thoughts, that I wish to put into words in order to catch the fleeting moment, the passing image, the laughter, the joy, and sometimes the sorrow. Life would be intolerable if I did not have this freedom to write every day. Not that everything I put down is worth preserving. A great many pages of manuscripts have found their way

into my waste-paper basket or into the stove that warms the family room on cold winter evenings. I do not always please myself. I cannot always please others because, unlike the hard professionals, the Forsyths and the Sheldons, I am not writing to please everyone, I am really writing to please myself!

My theory of writing is that the conception should be as clear as possible, and that words should flow like a stream of clear water, preferably a mountain stream! You will, of course, encounter boulders, but you will learn to go over them or around them, so that your flow is unimpeded. If your stream gets too sluggish or muddy, it is better to put aside that particular piece of writing. Go to the source, go to the spring, where the water is purest, your thoughts as clear as the mountain air.

I do not write for more than an hour or two in the course of the day. Too long at the desk, and words lose their freshness.

Together with clarity and a good vocabulary, there must come a certain elevation of mood. Sterne must have been bubbling over with high spirits when he wrote *Shandy*. The sombre intensity of *Wuthering Heights* reflects Emily Brontë's passion for life, fully knowing that it was to be brief. Tagore's melancholy comes through in his poetry. Dickens is always passionate; there are no half measures in his work. Conrad's prose takes on the moods of the sea he knew and loved.

A real physical emotion accompanies the process of writing, and great writers are those who can channel this emotion into the creation of their best work.

Are you a serious writer? a schoolboy once asked.

Well, I try to be serious, I said, but cheerfulness keeps breaking in!

Can a cheerful writer be taken seriously? I don't know. But I was certainly serious about making writing the main occupation of my life.

In order to do this, one has to give up many things—a job, security, comfort, domesticity— or rather, the pursuit of these things. Had I married when I was twenty-five, I would not have been able to throw up a good job as easily as I did at the time; I might now be living on a pension! God forbid. I am grateful for continued independence and the necessity to keep writing for my living, and for those who share their lives with me and whose joys and sorrows are mine too. An artist must not lose his hold on life. We do that when we settle for the safety of a comfortable old age.

Normally writers do not talk much, because they are saving their conversation for the readers of their books—those invisible listeners with whom we wish to strike a

sympathetic chord. Of course, we talk freely with our friends, but we are reserved with people we do not know very well. If I talk too freely about a story I am going to write, chances are it will never be written. I have talked it to death.

Being alone is vital for any creative writer. I do not mean that you must live the life of a recluse. People who do not know me are frequently under the impression that I live in lonely splendour on a mountain top, whereas in reality, I share a small flat with a family of twelve—and I'm the twelfth man, occasionally bringing out refreshments for the players!

I love my extended family, every single individual in it, but as a writer I must sometimes get a little time to be alone with my own thoughts, reflect a little, talk to myself, laugh about all the blunders I have committed in the past, and ponder over the future. This is contemplation, not meditation. I am not very good at meditation, as it involves remaining in a passive state for some time. I would rather be out walking, observing the natural world, or sitting under a tree contemplating my novel or navel! I suppose the latter is a form of meditation.

When I casually told a journalist that I planned to write a book consisting of my meditations, he reported that I was writing a book on meditation per se, which gave it a different connotation. I shall go along with the simple dictionary meaning of the verb meditate—to plan mentally, to exercise the mind in contemplation.

So I was doing it all along!

I am not, by nature, a gregarious person. Although I love people, and have often made friends with complete strangers, I am also a lover of solitude. Naturally, one thinks better when one is alone. But I prefer walking alone to walking with others. That ladybird on the wild rose would escape my attention if I was engaged in a lively conversation with a companion. Not that the ladybird is going to change my life. But by acknowledging its presence, stopping to admire its beauty, I have paid obeisance to the natural scheme of things of which I am only a small part.

It is upon a person's power of holding fast to such undimmed beauty that his or her inner hopefulness depends. As we journey through the world, we must inevitably encounter meanness and selfishness. As we fight for our survival, the higher visions and ideals often fade. It is then that we need ladybirds! Contemplating that tiny creature, or the flower on which it rests, gives one the hope—better, the certainty—that there is more to life than interest rates, dividends, market forces, and infinite technology.

As a writer, I have known hope and despair, success and failure; some recognition but also long periods of neglect and critical dismissal. But I have had no regrets. I have

enjoyed the writer's life to the full, and one reason for this is that living in India has given me certain freedoms which I would not have enjoyed elsewhere. Friendship when needed. Solitude when desired. Even, at times, love and passion. It has tolerated me for what I am—a bit of a dropout, unconventional, idiosyncratic. I have been left alone to do my own thing. In India, people do not censure you unless you start making a nuisance of yourself. Society has its norms and its orthodoxies, and provided you do not flaunt all the rules, society will allow you to go your own way. I am free to become a naked ascetic and roam the streets with a begging bowl; I am also free to live in a palatial farmhouse if I have the wherewithal. For twenty-five years, I have lived in this small, sunny second-floor room looking out on the mountains, and no one has bothered me, unless you count the neighbour's dog who prevents the postman and courier boys from coming up the steps.

I may write for myself, but as I also write to get published, it must follow that I write for others too. Only a handful of readers might enjoy my writing, but they are my soulmates, my alter egos, and they keep me going through those lean times and discouraging moments.

Even though I depend upon my writing for a livelihood, it is still, for me, the most delightful thing in the world. I did not set out to make a fortune from writing; I knew I was not that kind of writer. But it was the thing I did best, and I persevered with the exercise of my gift, cultivating the more discriminating editors, publishers, and readers, never really expecting huge rewards but accepting whatever came my way. Happiness is a matter of temperament rather than circumstance, and I have always considered myself fortunate in having escaped the tedium of a nine-to-five job or some other form of drudgery.

Of course, there comes a time when almost every author asks himself what his effort and output really amount to. We expect our work to influence people, to affect a great many readers, when in fact, its impact is infinitesimal. Those who work on a large scale must feel discouraged by the world's indifference. That is why I am happy to give a little innocent pleasure to a handful of readers. This is a reward worth having.

As a writer, I have difficulty in doing justice to momentous events, the wars of nations, the politics of power; I am more at ease with the dew of the morning, the sensuous delights of the day, the silent blessings of the night, the joys and sorrows of children, the strivings of ordinary folk and, of course, the ridiculous situations in which we sometimes find ourselves.

We cannot prevent sorrow and pain and tragedy. And yet when we look around us, we find that the majority of people are actually enjoying life! There are so many lovely things to see, there is so much to do, so much fun to be had, and so many charming and interesting people to meet... How can my pen ever run dry.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Ruskin Bond, an icon of Indian literature, has carved a niche for himself through his enchanting stories that capture the essence of the Indian landscape and its people. Born on May 19, 1934, in Kasauli, Himachal Pradesh, Bond's childhood spent amidst the hills laid the foundation for his deep connection with nature, a recurring theme in his writings. Raised by his English parents and later sent to live with his grandmother in Dehradun after his parents' separation, Bond's formative years were filled with a blend of British and Indian influences, which reflect in his diverse literary palette.

Bond's writing style is marked by its simplicity, clarity, and lyrical beauty. His prose flows like a gentle stream, carrying readers along on a journey of discovery and self-reflection. Whether he's describing the sights and sounds of a bustling market or the quiet solitude of a moonlit night, Bond's language evokes a sense of wonder and awe, reminding us of the beauty that surrounds us in everyday life.

SUMMARY

"Joyfully I Write" by Ruskin Bond is an introspective essay where the author reflects on his lifelong passion for writing. Bond shares anecdotes from his childhood, his inspirations, and the joys and challenges of being a writer. He emphasizes the intrinsic satisfaction he derives from crafting stories and the simple, unpretentious life he leads in the hills of India. Through this essay, Bond conveys his deep connection to nature and the written word, highlighting how writing is not just a profession but a fulfilling and joyous way of life. The essay encapsulates Bond's philosophy that writing is a labor of love, driven by curiosity and a desire to connect with readers.

THEME

Ruskin Bond's literary legacy is a testament to the enduring power of storytelling. His themes of nature, innocence, human relationships, coupled with his techniques of simple language, vivid imagery, and subtle humour, create a literary tapestry that captures the hearts of readers across generations.

Toba Tek Singh

SADAT HASAN MANTO

A couple of years after the partition of the country, it occurred to the respective governments of India and Pakistan that inmates of lunatic asylums, like prisoners, should also be exchanged. Muslim lunatics in India should be transferred to Pakistan and Hindu and Sikh lunatics in Pakistani asylums should be sent to India.

Whether this was a reasonable or an unreasonable idea is difficult to say. One thing, however, is clear. It took many conferences of important officials from the two sides to come to the decision. Final details, like the date of actual exchange, were carefully worked out. Muslim lunatics whose families were still residing in India were to be left undisturbed, the rest moved to the border for the exchange. The situation in Pakistan was slightly different, since almost the entire population of Hindus and Sikhs had already migrated to India. The question of keeping non-Muslim lunatics in Pakistan did not, therefore, arise.

While it is not known what the reaction in India was, when the news reached the Lahore lunatic asylum, it immediately became the subject of heated discussion. One Muslim lunatic, a regular reader of the fire-eating daily newspaper Zamindar, when asked what Pakistan was, replied after deep reflection, The name of a place in India where cut-throat razors are manufactured.

This profound observation was received with visible satisfaction.

A Sikh lunatic asked another Sikh, Sardarji, why are we being sent to India? We don't even know the language they speak in that country.

The man smiled. I know the language of the Hindostanis. These devils always strut about as if they were the lords of the earth.

One day a Muslim lunatic, while taking his bath, raised the slogan Pakistan Zindabad with such enthusiasm that he lost his balance and was later found lying on the floor unconscious.

Not all inmates were mad. Some were perfectly normal, except that they were murderers. To spare them the hangman's noose, their families had managed to get them committed after bribing officials down the line. They probably had a vague idea why India was being divided and what Pakistan was, but, as for the present situation, they were equally clueless.

Newspapers were no help either, and the asylum guards were ignorant, if not illiterate. Nor was there anything to be learnt by eavesdropping on their conversations. Some said there was this man by the name Muhammad Ali Jinnah, or the Quaid-e-Azam, who had set up a separate country for Muslims, called Pakistan.

As to where Pakistan was located, the inmates knew nothing. That was why both the mad and the partially mad were unable to decide whether they were now in India or in Pakistan. If they were in India, where on earth was Pakistan? And if they were in Pakistan, then how come that until only the other day it was India?

One inmate had got so badly caught up in this India-Pakistan-Pakistan-India rigmarole that one day, while sweeping the floor, he dropped everything, climbed the nearest tree and installed himself on a branch, from which vantage point he spoke for two hours on the delicate problem of India and Pakistan. The guards asked him to get down; instead he went a branch higher, and when threatened with punishment, declared, I wish to live neither in India nor in Pakistan. I wish to live in this tree.

When he was finally persuaded to come down, he began embracing his Sikh and Hindu friends, tears running down his cheeks, fully convinced that they were about to leave him and go to India.

A Muslim radio engineer, who had an M.Sc degree, and never mixed with anyone, given as he was to taking long walks by himself all day, was so affected by the current debate that one day he took off all his clothes, gave the bundle to one of the attendants and ran into the garden stark naked.

A Muslim lunatic from Chaniot, who used to be one of the most devoted workers of the All India Muslim League, and obsessed with bathing himself fifteen or sixteen times a day, had suddenly stopped doing that and announced his name was Muhammad Ali—that he was Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah. This had led a Sikh inmate to declare himself Master Tara Singh, the leader of the Sikhs. Apprehending serious communal trouble, the authorities declared them dangerous, and shut them up in separate cells.

There was a young Hindu lawyer from Lahore who had gone off his head after an unhappy love affair. When told that Amritsar was to become a part of India, he went into a depression because his beloved lived in Amritsar, something he had not forgotten even in his madness. That day he abused every major and minor Hindu and Muslim leader who had cut India into two, turning his beloved into an Indian and him into a Pakistani.

When news of the exchange reached the asylum, his friends offered him congratulations, because he was now to be sent to India, the country of his beloved. However, he declared

that he had no intention of leaving Lahore, because his practice would not flourish in Amritsar.

There were two Anglo-Indian lunatics in the European ward. When told that the British had decided to go home after granting independence to India, they went into a state of deep shock and were seen conferring with each other in whispers the entire afternoon. They were worried about their changed status after independence. Would there be a European ward or would it be abolished? Would breakfast continue to be served or would they have to subsist on bloody Indian chapatti?

(Bhishan Singh) is the name of the person and his village was (toba tek singh)

There was another inmate, a Sikh, who had been confined for the last fifteen years. Whenever he spoke, it was the same mysterious gibberish: *Uper the gur gur the annexe the bay dhayana the fining the dal of the laltain*. Guards said he had not slept a wink in fifteen years. Occasionally, he could be observed leaning against a wall, but the rest of the time, he was always to be found standing. Because of this, his legs were permanently swollen, something that did not appear to bother him. Recently, he had started to listen carefully to discussions about the forthcoming exchange of Indian and Pakistani lunatics. When asked his opinion, he observed solemnly, *Uper the gur gur the annexe the bay dhayana the mung the dal of the Government of Pakistan*.

Of late, however, the Government of Pakistan had been replaced by the government of Toba Tek Singh, a small town in the Punjab which was his home. He had also begun inquiring where Toba Tek Singh was to go. However, nobody was quite sure whether it was in India or Pakistan.

Those who had tried to solve this mystery had become utterly confused when told that Sialkot, which used to be in India, was now in Pakistan. It was anybody's guess what was going to happen to Lahore, which was currently in Pakistan, but could slide into India any moment. It was also possible that the entire subcontinent of India might become Pakistan. And who could say if both India and Pakistan might not entirely vanish from the map of the world one day?

The old man's hair was almost gone and what little was left had become a part of the beard, giving him a strange, even frightening, appearance. However, he was a harmless fellow and had never been known to get into fights. Older attendants at the asylum said that he was a fairly prosperous landlord from Toba Tek Singh, who had quite suddenly gone mad. His family had brought him in, bound and fettered. That was fifteen years ago.

Once a month, he used to have visitors but, since the start of communal troubles in the Punjab, they had stopped coming. *His real name was Bishen Singh, but everybody called*

him Toba Tek Singh. He lived in a kind of limbo, having no idea what day of the week it was, or month, or how many years had passed since his confinement. However, he had developed a sixth sense about the day of the visit, when he used to bathe himself, soap his body, oil and comb his hair and put on clean clothes. He never said a word during these meetings, except occasional outbursts of, Uper the gur gur the annexe the bay dhayana the mung the dal of the laltain.

When he was first confined, he had left an infant daughter behind, now a pretty, young girl of fifteen. She would come occasionally, and sit in front of him with tears rolling down her cheeks. In the strange world that he inhabited, hers was just another face.

Since the start of this India-Pakistan caboodle, he had got into the habit of asking fellow inmates where exactly Toba Tek Singh was, without receiving a satisfactory answer, because nobody knew. The visits had also suddenly stopped. He was increasingly restless, but, more than that, curious. The sixth sense, which used to alert him to the day of the visit, had also atrophied.

He missed his family, the gifts they used to bring and the concern with which they used to speak to him. He was sure they would have told him whether Toba Tek Singh was in India or Pakistan. He also had a feeling that they came from Toba Tek Singh, where he used to have his home.

One of the inmates had declared himself God. Bishen Singh asked him one day if Toba Tek Singh was in India or Pakistan. The man chuckled. Neither in India nor in Pakistan, because, so far, we have issued no orders in this respect.

Bishen Singh begged God to issue the necessary orders so that his problem could be solved, but he was disappointed, as God appeared to be preoccupied with more pressing matters. Finally, he told him angrily, Uper the gur gur the annexe the mung the dal of Guruji da Khalsa and Guruji ki fateh .. jo boley so nihai sat sri akal.

What he wanted to say was, You don't answer my prayers because you are a Muslim god. Had you been a Sikh god, you would have been more of a sport.

A few days before the exchange was to take place, one of Bishen Singh's Muslim friends from Toba Tek Singh came to see him—the first time in fifteen years. Bishen Singh looked at him once and turned away, until a guard said to him, This is your old friend Fazal Din. He has come all the way to meet you.

Bishen Singh looked at Fazal Din and began to mumble something. Fazal Din placed his hand on his friend's shoulder and said, I have been meaning to come for some time to bring you news. All your family is well and has gone to India safely. I did what I could to help. **Your daughter Roop Kaur...** —he hesitated— She is safe too ... in India.

Bishen Singh kept quiet; Fazal Din continued, Your family-wanted me to make sure you were well. Soon you will be moving to India. What can I say, except that you should remember me to bhai Balbir Singh, bhai Vadhawa Singh and bahain Amrit Kaur. Tell bhai Balbir Singh that Fazal Din is well by the grace of God. The two brown buffaloes he left behind are well too. Both of them gave birth to calves, but, unfortunately, one of them died after six days. Say I think of them often and to write to me if there is anything I can do.

Then he added, Here, I brought you a nice treat from home. Bishen Singh took the gift and handed it to one of the guards. Where is Toba Tek Singh? he asked.

Where? Why, it is where it has always been. In India or in Pakistan? In India ... no, in Pakistan.

Without saying another word, Bishen Singh walked away, murmuring, Upur the gur gur the annexe the bay dhayana the mung the dal of the Pakistan and Hindustan dur fittay moitn.

Meanwhile, the exchange arrangements were rapidly being finalized. Lists of lunatics from the two sides had been exchanged between the governments, and the date of transfer fixed.

On a cold winter evening, buses full of Hindu and Sikh lunatics, accompanied by armed police and officials, began moving out of the Lahore asylum towards Wagha, the dividing line between India and Pakistan. Senior officials from the two sides in charge of exchange arrangements met, signed documents and the transfer got under way.

It was quite a job getting the men out of the buses and handing them over to officials. Some just refused to leave. Those who were persuaded to do so began to run pell-mell in every direction. Some were stark naked. All efforts to get them to cover themselves had failed because they couldn't be kept from tearing off their garments. Some were shouting abuse or singing. Others were weeping bitterly. Many fights broke out.

In short, complete confusion prevailed. Female lunatics were also being exchanged and they were even noisier. It was bitterly cold.

Most of the inmates appeared to be dead set against the entire operation. They simply could not understand why they were being forcibly removed, thrown into buses and driven to this strange place. There were slogans of Pakistan Zindabad and Pakistan Murdabad, followed by fights.

When Bishen Singh was brought out and asked to give his name so that it could be recorded in a register, he asked the official behind the desk, Where is Toba Tek Singh? In India or Pakistan?

Pakistan, he answered with a vulgar laugh.

Bishen Singh tried to run, but was overpowered by the Pakistani guards who tried to push him across the dividing line towards India. However, he wouldn't move. This is Toba Tek Singh, he announced. Under the gur gur the annex the bay dhayana mung the dal of Toba Tek Singh and Pakistan.

Many efforts were made to explain to him that Toba Tek Singh had already been moved to India, or would be moved immediately, but it had no effect on Bishen Singh. The guards even tried force, but soon gave up.

There he stood in no-man's-land on his swollen legs like a colossus.

Since he was a harmless old man, no further attempt was made to push him into India. He was allowed to stand where he wanted, while the exchange continued. The night wore on.

Just before sunrise, Bishen Singh, the man who had stood on his legs for fifteen years, screamed and as officials from the two sides rushed towards him, he collapsed to the ground.

There, behind barbed wire, on one side, lay India and behind more barbed wire, on the other side, lay Pakistan. In between, on a bit of earth, which had no name, lay Toba Tek Singh.

About the Author

Saadat Hasan Manto, the legendary Urdu writer, remains a towering figure in the literary world, known for his fearless exploration of the human condition and unflinching portrayal of societal taboos. Born on May 11, 1912, in Paproudi village near Samrala in Ludhiana district of Punjab, Manto's early life was marked by struggle and hardship, which deeply influenced his writing style and thematic concerns.

Manto's literary career began in the 1930s when he moved to Bombay (now Mumbai) to pursue his passion for writing. In the bustling metropolis, he found inspiration in the vibrant cultural milieu and the colorful characters that populated its streets. His early stories, infused with a sense of realism and social critique, garnered widespread acclaim, establishing him as a rising star in the world of Urdu literature. Manto's writing is characterized by its raw intensity, searing honesty, and uncompromising portrayal of the human psyche. He fearlessly confronted taboo subjects such as sexuality, violence, and social injustice, challenging conventional norms and exposing the hypocrisies of society. His stories, often set against the backdrop of Partition and its aftermath, offer a poignant commentary on the human cost of communal strife and political upheaval. Despite facing censorship and persecution for his bold and controversial themes, Manto remained steadfast in his commitment to truth and artistic integrity. He refused to compromise his vision or dilute his message to appease critics or conform to prevailing sensibilities. For Manto, writing was not just a vocation but a moral imperative—a means of bearing witness to the harsh realities of life and giving voice to the voiceless.

SUMMARY

"Toba Tek Singh" by Saadat Hasan Manto is a poignant short story set against the backdrop of the 1947 Partition of India. The narrative focuses on inmates of a Lahore mental asylum who are to be exchanged between India and Pakistan. The central character, Bishan Singh, nicknamed Toba Tek Singh after his hometown, grapples with the news of this exchange. Confused about which country his village now belongs to, Bishan Singh refuses to move. In a powerful climax, he lies down in no man's land between the two borders, symbolizing the dislocation and madness caused by the Partition. The story critiques the political upheaval and human cost of arbitrary divisions, underscoring the futility and tragedy of such disruptions.

THEME: Confusion, identity, separation, change, control and ignorance.